

Defends Cohen, baseball team

Editor, The Prospector:

The article in the Feb. 7 issue of the Prospector concerning the Miner Baseball team and Coach Andy Cohen was misconstrued in its context with unsubstantiated facts and mis-leading opinions.

Feeling that the team has been misrepresented, I would like to offer the following points in retaliation:

—Andy Cohen is perfectly capable coach and as for as being too old, that is a false assumption. Both Coach Cohen and his brother Syd, who coaches the pitching staff, devote their time and knowledge to the team. Both men receive the deserved respect from the team.

—No team can have a winning season with a losing budget. Compared to the football budget of \$408,000, the baseball team received only \$12,000, a mere 3 per cent of that of football. This figure represents a decrease in the baseball budget of \$74, compared with an increase of \$50,000 in the football budget. The money allotted to baseball probably cannot even cover the cost of road uniforms,

since the team must rely on hand-me-down charity uniforms.

—Team needs new attitude? The attitude this year is one of a competitive nature to win, considering the fact that the Miners do not even have a field on University property they can call “home.”

—No other UT El Paso sport plays 55 games in one season, spends almost six months preparing and competing, and plays a professional team in exhibition. Being a member of probably the strongest collegiate baseball conference in the nation, many prominent teams desire to place our school on their schedule. One team who succeeded in making our schedule is the Big Eight Conference champion, the University of Oklahoma.

—Considering these factors, it cannot be surmised that the Miner team is in a “deep hole of oblivion.” Being tabbed “low man on the totem pole” is one unidentified person’s opinion of the baseball team, but the athletes of the team view the situation in an entirely different perspective.

A loyal fan